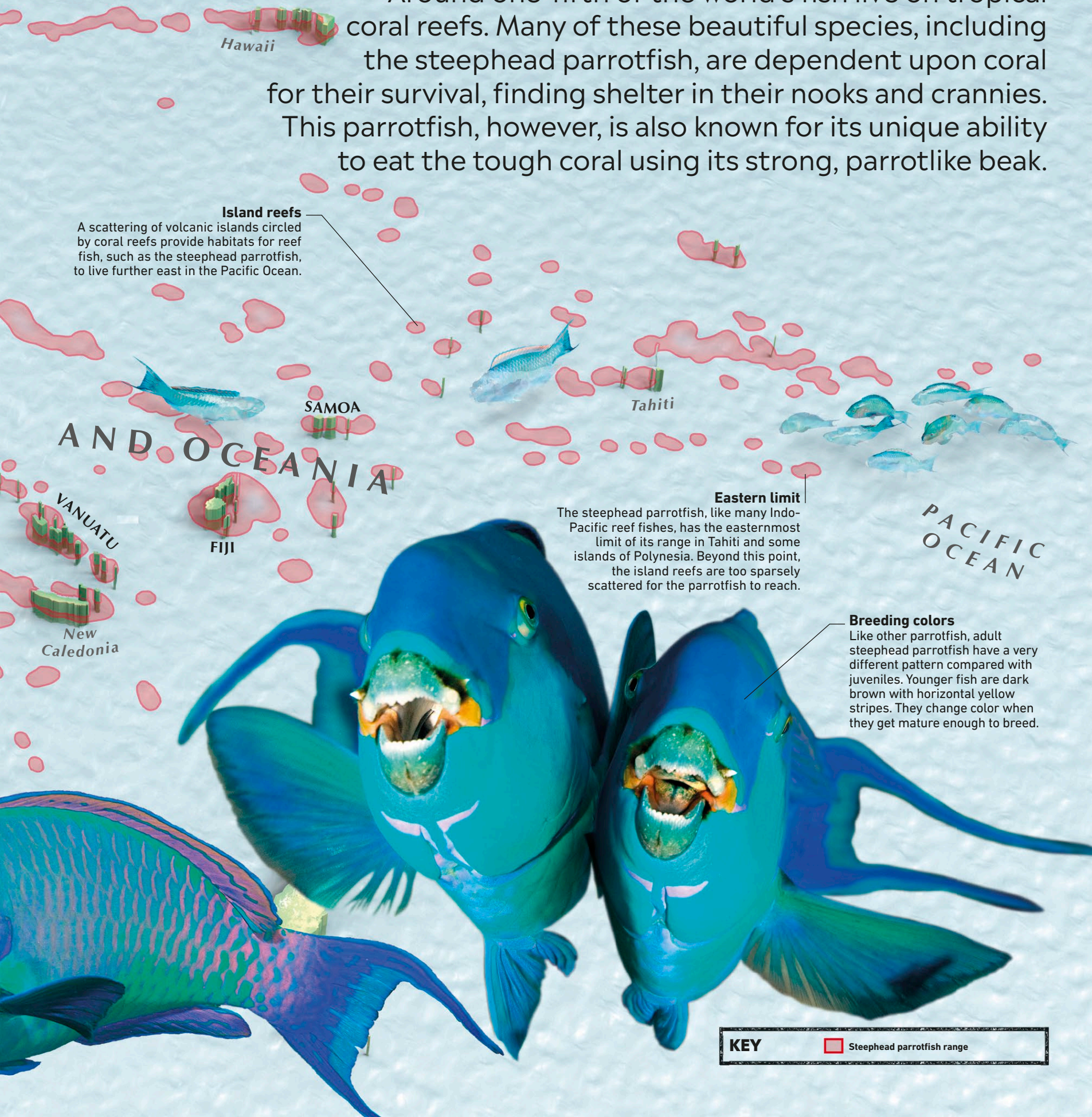


Steephead parrotfish

Around one-fifth of the world's fish live on tropical coral reefs. Many of these beautiful species, including the steephead parrotfish, are dependent upon coral for their survival, finding shelter in their nooks and crannies. This parrotfish, however, is also known for its unique ability to eat the tough coral using its strong, parrotlike beak.



Hawaii

Island reefs

A scattering of volcanic islands circled by coral reefs provide habitats for reef fish, such as the steephead parrotfish, to live further east in the Pacific Ocean.

SAMOA

Tahiti

AND OCEANIA

VANUATU

FIJI

New Caledonia

Eastern limit

The steephead parrotfish, like many Indo-Pacific reef fishes, has the easternmost limit of its range in Tahiti and some islands of Polynesia. Beyond this point, the island reefs are too sparsely scattered for the parrotfish to reach.

PACIFIC OCEAN

Breeding colors

Like other parrotfish, adult steephead parrotfish have a very different pattern compared with juveniles. Younger fish are dark brown with horizontal yellow stripes. They change color when they get mature enough to breed.

KEY

Steephead parrotfish range